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Chair's letter

Our people remain the foundation of the business, and engagement scores improved for the third consecutive year. The integration of the acquired business is complete and the expected cost synergies have been delivered. Risk management processes were reviewed during the year and no significant weaknesses were identified. The board reviewed the results for the period and considers the group well placed for the year ahead. Cash generation was strong, allowing us to reduce net debt and to propose an increased final dividend. We continued to invest in product development while holding administrative costs broadly flat in real terms.

> *“We grew where it mattered: recurring revenue rose 21% and every region contributed.”*

Customer retention remained high across all regions, with particular strength in the mid-market segment. Cash generation was strong, allowing us to reduce net debt and to propose an increased final dividend. Recurring revenue now accounts for the large majority of the total, which improves visibility of future earnings. Customer retention remained high across all regions, with particular strength in the mid-market segment. The integration of the acquired business is complete and the expected cost synergies have been delivered.

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Business review

The board reviewed the results for the period and considers the group well placed for the year ahead. The integration of the acquired business is complete and the expected cost synergies have been delivered.

Our people remain the foundation of the business, and engagement scores improved for the third consecutive year. We expect market conditions to remain competitive and have planned accordingly, with a focus on efficiency[1].

We continued to invest in product development while holding administrative costs broadly flat in real terms. Our people remain the foundation of the business, and engagement scores improved for the third consecutive year.

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We continued to invest in product development while holding administrative costs broadly flat in real terms. Our people remain the foundation of the business, and engagement scores improved for the third consecutive year[2].

Supply chain conditions normalised during the second half, easing pressure on hardware margins. We expect market conditions to remain competitive and have planned accordingly, with a focus on efficiency.

Recurring revenue now accounts for the large majority of the total, which improves visibility of future earnings. The board reviewed the results for the period and considers the group well placed for the year ahead.

[1] Growth rates are stated at constant currency unless otherwise noted.

[2] Includes the acquired Lumen Hardware business from 1 March 2026.

Consolidated income statement

For the year ended 31 December 2026

	Note	Year ended 31 December 2026 £m	2025 £m
Revenue	3	1,842.6	1,523.1
Cost of sales		(1,011.4)	(861.9)
Gross profit		**831.2**	**661.2**
Distribution costs		(142.0)	(120.7)
Administrative expenses		(318.5)	(289.9)
Exceptional items[3]	5	(22.1)	—
Operating profit		**348.6**	**250.6**
Finance income		6.2	3.1
Finance costs		(31.8)	(36.4)
Profit before tax		**323.0**	**217.3**
Taxation	6	(80.8)	(52.1)
Profit for the year		**242.2**	**165.2**
Earnings per share			
Basic (pence)	7	41.2	33.5
Diluted (pence)	7	40.6	33.0

[3] Exceptional items comprise acquisition costs and the restructuring of the European distribution network.

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Outlook

Customer retention remained high across all regions, with particular strength in the mid-market segment. The integration of the acquired business is complete and the expected cost synergies have been delivered. Our people remain the foundation of the business, and engagement scores improved for the third consecutive year.

Cash generation was strong, allowing us to reduce net debt and to propose an increased final dividend. Risk management processes were reviewed during the year and no significant weaknesses were identified. The board reviewed the results for the period and considers the group well placed for the year ahead.

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“Our priority for 2027 is disciplined growth: more customers, deeper relationships, steady margins.”

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Segment information

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	Revenue		Operating profit		
Segment	**2026**	**2025**	**2026**	**2025**	**Margin 2026**
Software	1,120.4	902.7	261.8	188.0	23.4%
Services	402.9	371.5	52.3	44.1	13.0%
Hardware	214.0	168.2	21.9	12.6	10.2%
Payments	105.3	80.7	12.6	5.9	12.0%
Total	**1,842.6**	**1,523.1**	**348.6**	**250.6**	**18.9%**

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Forward-looking statements

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Shareholder information

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